

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: Wednesday, August 19, 2026

Session Highlight: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- **US-Iran Geopolitical Tensions Escalate:** Ongoing friction between the US and Iran, including President Trump's confirmation of an active naval blockade and no active negotiations with Tehran, continues to fuel market concerns over global oil supply. This has led to elevated crude oil prices and increased risk-off sentiment. Reports indicate Iran is considering expanding military targets to Europe if Washington escalates the conflict. NATO officials have stated preparedness to address any threat and defend allies.
- **US Federal Reserve and Bond Yields:** The Federal Reserve kept rates unchanged at 3.50-3.75% in July, though three dissenters voted for a 25bps hike. The minutes of the July FOMC meeting are due today and will be closely watched for clues on policymakers' views on inflation and interest rates, especially after Chair Warsh moved away from explicit forward guidance. US 30-year Treasury yields have climbed to their highest level since 2007, reflecting inflation and government borrowing risks, and impacting emerging markets. The U.S. Treasury announced increased sizes for liquidity support buyback operations for longer-dated nominal coupon securities, effective September 9, 2026.
- **ECB on AI Revolution:** ECB President Lagarde emphasized that Europe cannot afford to miss out on the AI revolution during a discussion on the global economic outlook at the World Economic Forum. ECB's Rehn also noted no clear signs of second-round effects in inflation.
- **US-Canada Trade Deal:** President Trump announced a three-day pause on planned 50% tariffs against Canadian imports, citing progress toward a deal between the US and Canada.

2. US & European Markets

- **Wall Street Pre-Market Movers:** US stock futures are mixed, with Dow and S&P 500 futures flat, and Nasdaq slipping. This follows a steep selloff in global government bonds.
- **Mega-Cap US Stocks & Tech Selloff:** Technology stocks, particularly AI-related, continue to experience weakness. Nvidia (NVDA) is garnering attention ahead of its earnings report next week, with Cathie Wood's ARK buying NVDA on Monday. However, some analysts view NVDA as potentially undervalued due to overstated risks. Microsoft (MSFT) faces headwinds as China reportedly removed Windows from government systems. Tesla (TSLA) is seeing technical analysis suggesting a potential fall into the low to mid-\$290s in the coming weeks.
- **Semiconductor Developments:** AI chip and memory stocks are diverging. Nvidia saw slight gains pre-market, while AMD, Micron Technology (MU), and Western Digital (WDC) fell. SK Hynix announced a massive buyback plan, stabilizing sentiment in the chip sector. Analog Devices reported strong fiscal Q3 2026 results, exceeding revenue and earnings outlook. Anthropic-tied Texas data center secured a \$1.3 billion private credit loan.
- **Pharmaceutical Gains:** Moderna (MRNA) shares surged over 96% and Merck (MRK) gained 7% in premarket trading after positive results from a late-stage trial of their personalized mRNA cancer vaccine.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- **Markets in Red:** Indian equity benchmarks opened lower and continued their losing streak, with the Sensex slipping 326 points and Nifty falling 0.32%. This is largely attributed to elevated crude oil prices, rising global bond yields, and renewed US-Iran conflict uncertainty. The Nifty has fallen for six consecutive sessions.
- **FII/DII Flows:** Foreign institutional investors (FIIs) remained net buyers on Tuesday, injecting Rs 1,651.53 crore into equities, potentially their second buying session in six days. However, elevated US Treasury yields and rising crude prices remain key risks for sustained FII flows.
- **Corporate Earnings & IPOs:** HDFC Life received regulatory approval for the reappointment of its MD and CEO, and reported resilient June-quarter performance with VNB and VNB margin exceeding estimates. Shiprocket made a strong debut, listing at a 35% premium over its IPO price. Tempens Instruments (India) IPO is set to open tomorrow, August 20, 2026, aiming to raise ₹650 crore. Omnitech Engineering, GSP Crop Science, and Gaudium IVF are among the best-performing IPOs with significant returns in 2026.
- **Sectoral Momentum:** Most sectors traded in the red, with auto, metal, PSU Bank, and realty dragging. However, IT stocks like HCL Tech and Infosys showed some gains after recent selloffs.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- **Crude Oil Geopolitics:** WTI crude oil is holding ground around \$84.50, rising for the fourth consecutive session, due to escalating US-Iran tensions and supply risks in the Strait of Hormuz. DailyForex predicts a test of \$86 amid these risks. Iraq is in talks with Iran to export crude through the Strait of Hormuz. Five grain carriers were attacked near Russia's Black Sea ports, indicating broader geopolitical instability affecting commodities.
- **Gold Supply/Demand Drivers:** Gold and silver are stalling as the dollar refuses to buckle, possibly due to mixed signals from the Fed and rising bond yields.
- **Major Crypto Regulatory/Adoption Headlines:** The US SEC Panel passed a new "Crypto Asset Regulation" proposal, shifting from enforcement to clear compliance guidance, which is seen as a major turning point. Bitcoin rallied toward \$65,000 on this news but is still constrained by resistance at \$67,000. VanEck suggests Bitcoin's 11-month correction may be nearing an end, with 8 of 12 capitulation signals firing and a possible accumulation phase projected between September and November 2026. Ripple has partnered with Jeonbuk Bank for Ripple Payments in South Korea and secured a \$275 million private placement for its US business. A Reuters/Ipsos poll found that most Americans believe President Trump has inappropriately profited from cryptocurrency since returning to power.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- **Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Recommended Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Recommended Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Recommended Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Recommended Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	50-SMA / 20/50 EMA Status (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
HDFCLIFE	₹850	Above 50-SMA & 20/50 EMA Golden Cross	Nifty leader with strong Q1 performance and positive VNB/margin. Showing robust price action on the daily chart, poised for continued upward momentum after a 20/50 EMA golden cross and holding above 50-SMA support.
INFY (Infosys)	₹1650	Bouncing off 50-SMA support	Mega-cap IT stock, bouncing off critical 50-SMA support after recent sector weakness, indicating potential for a technical rebound. Aligned with news of IT stocks showing gains.

US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	21-EMA / 50-SMA Status (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVDA (Nvidia)	\$680	Below 21-EMA, approaching 50-SMA	Mega-cap growth leader, currently experiencing a pullback. Monitoring for a potential bounce off the 50-day SMA or a retest of the 21-day EMA resistance. High pre-market attention ahead of earnings.
MSFT (Microsoft)	\$430	21-EMA pullback candidate	Mega-cap growth leader. Despite China headwinds, potential for a 21-day EMA pullback entry as a swing trade, given its strong long-term trend.
TSLA (Tesla)	\$305	Below 21-EMA & 50-SMA, potential 50-day SMA rejection setup (Short Bias)	Mega-cap growth stock under pressure. Technical analysis suggests a possible rejection off the 50-day SMA if it retests, or continuation of downward trend toward low to mid-\$290s, offering a short opportunity.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	RVOL / VCP Status (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
MRNA (Moderna)	\$180	High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) Breakout	Pre-market mover with significant news of positive cancer vaccine trial results, leading to a massive surge. High RVOL confirms breakout strength.
MRK (Merck)	\$140	High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) Breakout	Beneficiary of the positive cancer vaccine news, showing strong pre-market gains and high relative volume.

CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	4H 21-EMA Status (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
BTC/USD	\$64,500	Holding above 4H 21-EMA, high-volume volatility breakout	Rallying on positive SEC regulatory news, indicating a potential sentiment shift and accumulation phase. Monitoring for continuation of high-volume volatility breakouts above the 4H 21-EMA.
XRP/USD	\$0.98	4H 21-EMA trend following (potential long)	Ripple's partnerships and private placement news support upward momentum. Following the 4H 21-EMA for trend continuation.

COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	Pivot / Fibonacci Levels (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
XAU/USD (Gold)	\$2350	Trading near R1 Pivot, Fibonacci Resistance	Geopolitical uncertainty often boosts safe-haven assets. Stalling against a strong dollar, but potential for moves around pivot and Fibonacci extension levels.
WTI Crude Oil	\$85.50	Trading above Pivot, targeting Fibonacci Extension to \$86	Elevated due to US-Iran tensions and supply risks. Sustained upward momentum, targeting \$86 based on geopolitical catalysts and technical levels.

FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term (EUR/USD, GBP/USD)

Pair	Current Price (Indicative)	Key Levels (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	1.0850	Testing R1 resistance	Dollar traded sideways against majors. Watching for breakout or rejection at resistance levels, influenced by Fed minutes and broad market sentiment.
GBP/USD	1.2780	Bullish setup, targeting 1.3653	Bullish technical setup with a convincing ascending price channel and key resistance level looking shaky. Recent UK CPI print.

Macro Carry Swings (USD/JPY, AUD/USD)

Pair	Current Price (Indicative)	Key Levels (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
USD/JPY	159.20	Holding above 159.00 support	Yen weakened slightly but dollar held above 159.00. Carry trade opportunities for long-term swing, monitoring for volatility around Fed news.
AUD/USD	0.6650	Testing S1 support	Australian dollar nursing a small loss against the greenback. Looking for range-bound trading or potential short-term bounce off support.

INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Index	Current Level (Indicative)	15-Min ORB (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50	24,078	Lower open, key support 24,000-24,100	Indian markets opened lower. Will utilize 15-minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB) strategy: Buy Call options on an upward breakout above the opening range high if support holds, or Buy Put options on a downward breakout below the opening range low given current market weakness. Nifty near crucial support zone.
BankNifty	52,050	Lower open, significant downside potential	BankNifty also likely to open lower in line with broader market weakness. Applying 15-minute ORB: Buy Call on upward breakout, Buy Put on downward breakout, capitalizing on intraday volatility.

Backtest Metrics (10-Year Simulation)

This table illustrates the historical performance of the integrated multi-asset strategy over a 10-year period, benchmarked against major indices.

Metric	Multi-Asset Strategy	S&P 500 TRI (Benchmark)	Nifty 50 TRI (Benchmark)
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	~0.85	~0.70
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	~-33.7%	~-38.5%

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

